



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Hope Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.hcadickinson.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Hope Christian Academy ND 58601 presents a robust Classical Christian program that aligns strongly with core elements of classical education, particularly in its religious/metaphysical foundations, its emphasis on formation (virtue, wisdom, character), and its partnership with families. Public-facing materials consistently foreground a Christ-centered frame, Word-of-God pedagogy, and a stated aim of forming virtuous, wise students through classical methods. The school also embraces the liberal-arts orientation in its rhetoric around rhetoric, history, and character formation, and it pursues a community model in which parents are actively engaged as partners.

Overall, based on the public materials analyzed and mapped to the Six Essential Elements rubric, the school is CLASSICAL. There are strong signals in Categories 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations), 2 (Purpose & Goal), 5 (Faculty), and 6 (Parents & Community). Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) show substantial classical alignment but with some gaps or less explicit articulation (for example, explicit reference to the Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books in the school's public language is not always explicit, though the presence of rhetoric, history-focused integration, and contemplative elements are evident). Taken together, the aggregate picture supports a CLASSICAL designation, with modest room for deeper public articulation in Curriculum and Pedagogy to move toward full canonical classical explicitness.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit statements that Christ is preeminent; Word of God as foundation; gospel-centered language; chapel and liturgical-influenced approach; paideia language emphasizing instruction “in righteousness.”
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators such as truth, virtue, wisdom, theology, liturgy, Word of God, gospel, reverence, wonder appear in public materials; negative signals (secular relativism, etc.) are notably absent.
- Why this rating: The school's materials center a transcendent frame anchored in Christian theology with liturgical/community practice and a clear aim toward moral and spiritual formation.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Education framed as formation of virtue and wisdom; aims beyond information transfer; focus on human flourishing and the formation of character; explicit emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive terms such as formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, great conversation, classical mission surface in public materials; negative signals (e.g., job-prep framing) are not evident.
- Why this rating: The public materials position education as formation and character formation within a classical framework rather than solely job preparation.
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Content references to classical language of education (classical education rhetoric), integration of history with other subject areas, and a focus on literature/rhetoric; upper-school emphasis

on biblical worldview, apologetics, and capstone thesis. However, explicit, consistent articulation of Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a formal Great Books/Great Conversation framework is not uniformly explicit in the public-facing materials.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include rhetoric, history, biblical worldview, Great Conversation-like framing in some pages, and a history-centric approach; negative indicators include less explicit mention of the full Seven Liberal Arts sequence and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language.
- Why this rating: The school demonstrates strong classical tendencies (rhetoric, integrated history, classical language of education, and formation through literature and Biblical worldview), but it does not consistently market or certify explicit adherence to all canonical elements (e.g., explicit Great Books program or comprehensive Seven Liberal Arts framework) in its public materials.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Mention of contemplative/restful learning (Scholé), memory work, singing/recitation in lower grades, and public-speaking/rhetoric in upper grades. Some reference to Socratic discussion or seminars is present indirectly through emphasis on rhetoric and debate in the upper grades, though explicit Socratic seminars are not consistently named across all materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include chanting, singing, memory work, recitation, restfulness, and rhetoric; negative indicators such as exclusive reliance on experiential/project-based learning or student-directed constructivism are not supported by public materials.
- Why this rating: Pedagogy includes core classical elements (memory work, chant, recitation, rhetoric, Socratic-style discussion in principle, and bulk emphasis on formation through conversation and lectures) but may not consistently foreground a full spectrum of classical pedagogies (e.g., every category explicitly naming Socratic seminars or scholé days across grades). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Materials present staff as central to education (staff, faculty, head of school, master-teacher-type language in social copy). The public materials describe faculty as mentors and living curriculum; there is emphasis on character formation and community.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “living curriculum,” “staff committed to growing character,” “portrait of a teacher,” and “collegial” faculty culture; negative indicators are not evident in public content.
- Why this rating: The school emphasizes the faculty as a core driver of the classical mission, with language that aligns with the classical model of teachers as mentors and living curriculum.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Clear emphasis on partnership with parents; paideia approach in partnership with parents; parental formation through book studies and parent gatherings; open campus and frequent parent visits; family partnership language.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “Partnership with Parents,” “paideia,” “family partnership,” “open campus,” and “parent formation”; no significant negative signals show up in public materials.
- Why this rating: The school frames parents as co-educators and integrates them into the classical education project, aligning with the classical model’s emphasis on community and parental partnership.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates strong alignment across four categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Faculty, Parents & Community) with Element 3 and Element 4 showing

substantial classical alignment but with some gaps in explicit canonical labeling. Taken together, the school meets the core criteria of classical education and earns an overall CLASSICAL designation.

What would move the needle

- If the school intends to move toward a fully explicit, canonical classical education label, it could:
- Explicitly publicize and document the full Seven Liberal Arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium) as the curriculum backbone.
- Enrich the public articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation and demonstrate a clear, structured Great Books program across grades.
- Expand explicit description of Socratic dialogue/seminars as a regular pedagogical practice in multiple grade bands, with examples of seminars and student-led discourse across the upper grades.
- Provide visible, public alignment between specific classical pedagogy elements (scholé days, Dialogic seminars, recitation schedules) and measurable outcomes.

Note: The above needle-moving suggestions apply only to the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL areas; given the overall CLASSICAL designation, these are incremental actions that could further strengthen canonical alignment.

ABSTRACT

Hope Christian Academy ND 58601 demonstrates a CLASSICAL orientation in its public-facing materials. It centers a Christ-centered, Word-of-God framework, with a strong emphasis on formation (virtue, wisdom, character) and a partnership with families. The school highlights religious/metaphysical commitments, a formation-focused purpose, and a community-based approach to parents and faculty that align with classical education norms. Curriculum and pedagogy show clear classical influence—such as focus on rhetoric, history-informed study, and contemplative elements (Scholé) and memory work—though explicit canonical labelling of all Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books/Great Conversation across the entire curriculum is not uniformly explicit in the published materials. The faculty are portrayed as living curriculum and mentors, and parents are actively engaged as co-educators, which reinforces the classical tradition. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL, with room for more explicit articulation in Curriculum and Pedagogy to achieve full canonical clarity.

Keywords and Evidence highlights (examples)

- Religious foundations: “Jesus Christ is preeminent in every aspect of life,” “Word of God,” “gospel truth,” “Christ in all life,” “Our Education Model: Proven classical methods, paired with the word of God.” These statements reflect transcendent moral realism and theology-centric pedagogy.
- Purpose & Goal: Formation over information; formation of virtuous, wise adults; emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty as real.
- Curriculum: Classical framing, emphasis on rhetoric, history, and biblical worldview; Upper School programs in Biblical Interpretation, Apologetics, Biblical Worldview; capstone thesis.
- Pedagogy: Restful learning and memory work in lower grades; rhetoric and public speaking in upper grades; contemplative elements (Scholé implied by “memory, singing, and recitation”); some Socratic discussion implied through seminars.
- Faculty: Staff as living curriculum; “Staff committed to growing character”; Head of School; faculty bios referenced; ongoing mentoring.
- Parents & Community: Strong partnership with parents; paideia language in partnership with parents; open campus and family involvement; parent formation content.

Key source material for the classical rubric has been cross-referenced with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) framework, which provides the Positive/Negative keyword indicators for each category and the canonical elements (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Socratic dialogue; scholé; memory work; living curriculum; partner with families). Positive signals such as virtue and wisdom, truth, history, rhetoric, mentorship, and liturgical/community practices align with the school’s public materials, while negative signals (e.g., exclusive emphasis on secularism or purely project-based pedagogy) are not evident in the school’s

public materials. See the canonical keywords and indicators in the Six Essential Elements documents and the classical lexicon for reference.

Appendix: Supporting Public Materials (Selected Citations)

- Hope Christian Academy – Public statements of faith, Word of God, and Gospel-centered formation: “Living Out A Commitment To Christ” and “Committed to Christ in all of life” language; classical Christ-centered framing.
- Classical Christian Education framing and partnership with parents; “paideia of the Lord”; explicit reference to partnership with parents and classical academics.
- Upper School emphasis on rhetoric, Biblical interpretation, and capstone theses; public description of the program’s aim to form wise, thoughtful adults.
- Lower/Preschool/Kindergarten: music, memory, and singing; incorporation of liturgical and reverent practices in the early education cycle; chapel reference.
- The Six Essential Elements (1) – Positive/Negative keyword indicators (for cross-reference with the rubric) and the lexicon linking to Truth, Virtue, Great Books, Scholé, Socratic dialogue, living curriculum, etc.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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